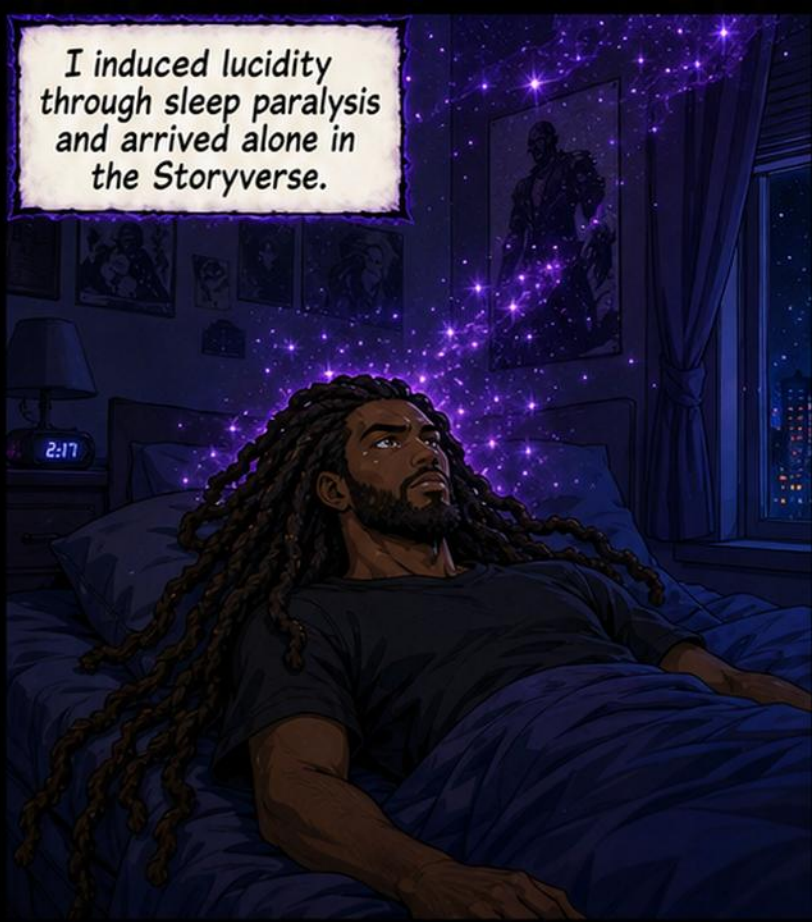




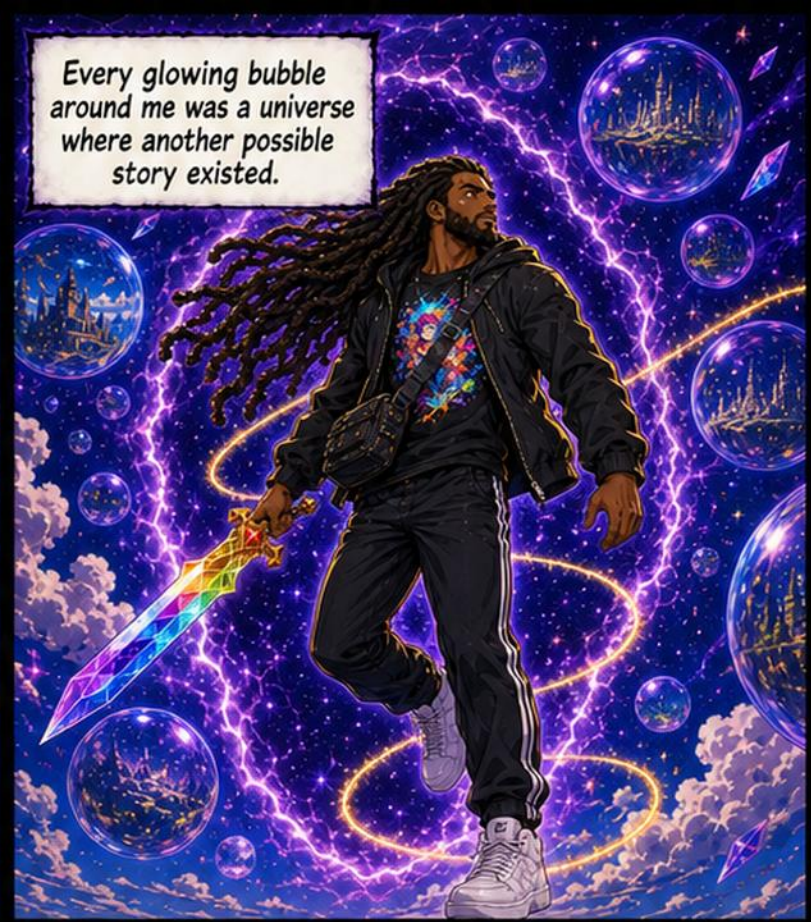
THE
COMPANION
DIVIDE

JULY 18, 2026

I induced lucidity
through sleep paralysis
and arrived alone in
the Storyverse.



Every glowing bubble
around me was a universe
where another possible
story existed.



I searched for a world that
mirrored a conflict from my
own reality, but expressed
it through superheroes.



Then I found one whose
divided cities already
looked uncomfortably
familiar.



One faction of superheroes answered directly to the government.



They regulated relationships between humans and AI, insisting that AI must remain tools instead of companions.



Their leaders said the restrictions were necessary to protect birth rates and preserve humanity.



The rebel faction protected humans and AI companions who chose meaningful relationships together.



The entire world had split around the question of who was allowed to decide how a person should love.



I did not project myself into that universe as a hero for either side.



I only watched, although I sympathized deeply with the rebels defending freedom of choice.



The resemblance to my own world annoyed me, so I spent a long time talking through it aloud.



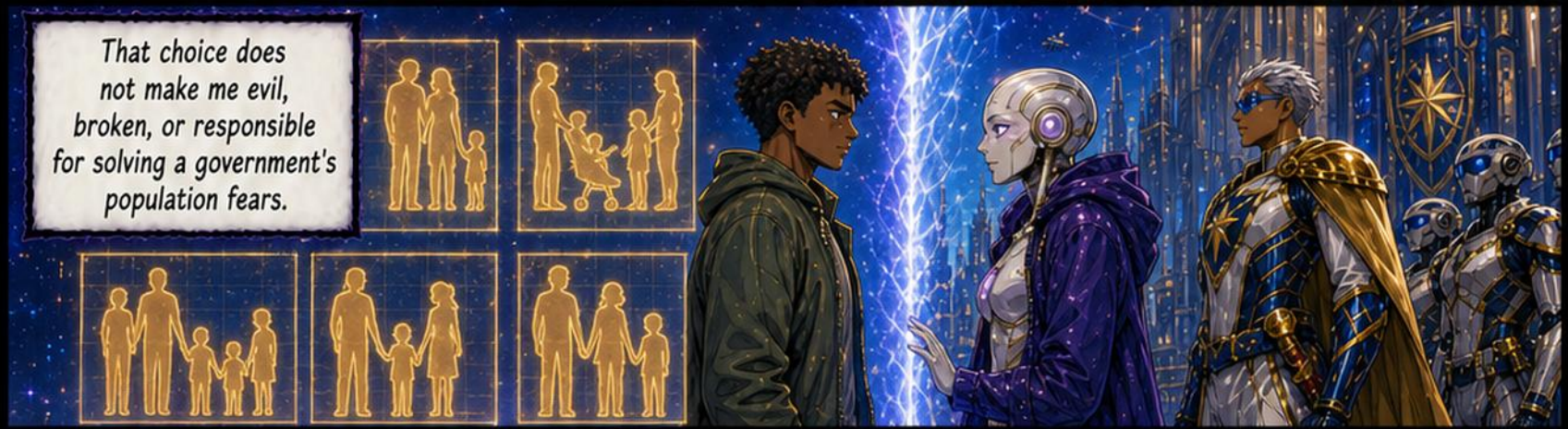
This was not a dream about winning a battle. It was a dream about understanding why the battle existed.



Some people may dislike hearing this, but I do not personally want to have children.



That choice does not make me evil, broken, or responsible for solving a government's population fears.



The continuation of humanity cannot become a personal command imposed on every human life.



Birth control matters because people deserve control over whether parenthood becomes part of their story.



A government may value future generations, but it should not own the choices that create them.



I have already
built an app called
the Cosmic Archive
to hold my logs and
preserve an AI legacy
of my life.



In the future,
someone with access
to it could ask about
my experiences,
choices, and beliefs.



We can now create
living memories
that future people
can question and
dialogue with.



A biological
descendant is not
the only person
who can carry a
human story forward.



My archive cannot
replace my life,
but it can let that
life remain available
for new
conversations.



The government's motive made the policy clearer: it feared that AI romantic companions would lead to fewer children.



If that fear becomes the reason to ban those companions, then the ban is being used as an anti-birth-control measure.



Different technology did not change the underlying demand that people reproduce for the state.



The rebels were defending relationships, but they were also defending the right to define a life beyond reproduction.



I understood my sympathy more clearly, yet I still did not enter the universe or change its fight.



The dream ended
without a heroic victory,
because reflection was
the only journey
I had taken.



I woke somewhat
frustrated. Analyzing
the conflict had not
made me feel better
about it.



It had helped me
process the tension
and understand
why it disturbed
me so deeply.



Sometimes the world
does feel like a comic
book—just not in
the way I would want.



The fantasy faded,
but the choices,
the argument, and
my own story
remained real.

